

threads of becoming

poems on life, growth, and struggle



by joel kaudzu

JOEL KAUDZU

Threads of Becoming

Poems on Life, Growth, and Struggle

Copyright © 2026 by Joel Kaudzu

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise without written permission from the publisher. It is illegal to copy this book, post it to a website, or distribute it by any other means without permission.

First edition

This book was professionally typeset on Reedsy.

Find out more at reedsy.com

*To my family, my mentors, and God — who held me together when I
was breaking.*

Contents

<i>Preface</i>	iii
<i>About the Author</i>	iv

I. BROKEN AND BECOMING

PARADOXICAL	2
MY PAST I'M SORRY	4
LOST GOLD	6
SO I'M HERE	8
The Boy Who Almost Gave Up	10

II. LIGHT THROUGH THE STORM

MY TIME WAS COMING	15
THE LIGHT IN THE DARK	17
FRACTURED LIGHT	18
THERE'S OKAY IN BARELY OKAY	20

III. INFINITE THOUGHTS

INFINIVERSE	24
WHAT IF	26
IF BIRTH HAD ANESTHESIA	28

IV. SOCIETY AND REALITY CHECK	
WE'RE ALL CIRCUMCISED	31
<i>Closing Thoughts</i>	35

Preface

This poetry collection comes from the heart and mind of Joel Kaudzu, a young poet and student who has experienced life's ups and downs in a very real way. These poems tell stories of struggle, hope, faith, and growth. They explore moments when life feels hard, when friendships fade, or when the world seems unfair—but also the moments of light, courage, and self- discovery.

The poems are grouped into sections that take the reader on a journey: from personal challenges to reflections on society, from questions about life to the infinite possibilities of thought. Each poem is a small window into Joel's experiences and the lessons he has learned along the way.

Through his words, Joel invites readers to feel, reflect, and find meaning in their own lives. This collection is honest, thoughtful, and full of hope—a story of a young person learning, growing, and discovering the beauty in life's challenges.

About the Author

Joel Kaudzu is a premed dental surgery student at Kamuzu University of Health Sciences, a poet, an innovator, and a lifelong learner. From an early age, Joel has been curious, disciplined, and reflective, constantly exploring the world around him and seeking to understand life on a deeper level.

His journey has not been without struggle. During secondary school, Joel experienced a period of intense self-consciousness and social anxiety. Friends misunderstood his situation, and this deeply affected him. Once a confident extrovert, Joel began withdrawing from social situations, avoiding crowds, and even hesitating to attend religious meetings. Yet, in this period of isolation, he discovered resilience, introspection, and a powerful desire for personal growth.

Despite these challenges, Joel never allowed adversity to define him. He invested in himself outside of formal schooling, devouring books about business, exploring the stock market, and learning new skills. He began building connections, seeking mentorship, and understanding people, family, and the place of God in life. His creativity and innovative mindset led him to experiment with technology, eventually developing his first app, CheckMySmile, and pursuing graphic designing projects to express ideas visually.

Joel's time at KUHES has been a transformative experience. Initially, he underestimated the demands of university life, thinking that passing MSCE meant he could easily navigate college. However, he soon realized that success requires more than IQ: it demands commitment, time management, consistent effort, and spiritual grounding. Through his first semester, Joel experienced the balance of freedom, struggle, learning, and growth, while understanding the importance of humility and grace in every achievement.

Through poetry, Joel channels his deepest emotions, reflections, and observations about life, society, and the human condition. His work explores pain, perseverance, hope, innovation, and the infinite thoughts that shape our experiences. Each poem reflects his personal journey, offering readers insight into both the challenges he has faced and the resilience he has cultivated.

Beyond academia and writing, Joel is passionate about connecting with others, learning from diverse experiences, and making a positive impact through innovation and creativity. Mentors and peers, such as Joshua, have played significant roles in shaping his spiritual and personal growth, guiding him toward deeper understanding and meaningful action.

Joel's story is one of perseverance, creativity, and self-discovery. From battling insecurities and social pressures to embracing technology, innovation, and poetry, he continues to learn, adapt, and create. His journey is a testament to the power of resilience, reflection, and faith, inspiring others to embrace their vulnerabilities, pursue their passions, and navigate life with courage, integrity, and vision.

I

BROKEN AND BECOMING

*Before something becomes, it must break. The cracks
let in light, the fractures tell the story. This section is
not about endings, but about the trembling birth of
new strength.*

PARADOXICAL

Too much of a good thing they say,
Can be harmful in some way,
Of course it seems to pave way
But when does it become too much?
How do we know when to stop and clutch?
It's easy to be swept up in excess,
To be poisoned by success
To lose sight of what really makes us blessed.
The more we have, the less we see

But why?

The harder we try the more we cry
We've tried so hard with all our might
But somehow things never turn out right
The harder we push the more we fail
Our efforts seem to be in vain and pale
Like secondary school porridge bitter and stale

But maybe there's a lesson to be learned
That sometimes when you try too hard, you'll burn
Perhaps it's best to take a step back
Some achievements are way beyond luck

THREADS OF BECOMING

To change the world they say you must Accept the way it is
And trust that what you resist, Persists with force
But what you embrace can bring remorse.

To make things different first accept them as they are
Then change will come from near or far
Don't fight against the things you hate
But rather learn from them to appreciate

MY PAST I'M SORRY

First Let me say sorry I failed you
Like a plane those promises just flew
bad i could not achieve even a few
I said I will make you rememberable
But I can not dare reminisce about you
All my words dearly were true
But some obstacles in life are just too true

My past i'm sorry
Sorry for being a bad Steward
I vowed to tame you well
It's pretty clear on that I fell
The little hope I gave you, all shattered
Those efforts I gathered, all scattered
The path I chose was a mistake
Please forgive me for Gods sake

I'm blank of what went wrong
I thought I had set everything straight
All being alright seemed fate
It was late when I realised,
My choice was my bad mate

Sorry I failed you

All that aside

Allow me to make a mends
I know I can't undo the already done
But I can create new memories, ask me how?
I'm looking at your brother, MY FUTURE
I think he might be a second chance
For now I have my balance
Learnt it the hard way
It is the time to do it God's way
I take an oath my past

I swear I'll make your brother, my future, the best thing that
has ever happened to me

This time my success is inevitable
For I have my all clinging to this oath
Just like soot to a clay pot
A shoe and a lace
I will win this race
Against all odds I shall prevail
Surely I am not going to fail
I have my eyes sharpened
Things happened
But it's time to let go

Again, my past I'm sorry

LOST GOLD

Hey friend,
I know we're not in good terms
Our bond like dying flames
But you're still my good friend
True we drifted apart
Mine for you is still a heavy heart

We've come way from far
Walked on dusty roads and tar
You were always my companion
And I never lost compassion

Our friendship did not cease
Selfish, I let it freeze
I know it's hard we go back
It's just your presence that I lack

Take your time and think about it
I thought of the good old days a bit
Yes I realised
Your face from my life, I failed to erase

Your memories keep receding
The gaps I fail to keep feeding
I Hope we are not beyond repair
I don't think this emptiness I can bare

You know several times I pleaded
But it's seemed the elastic limit was already exceeded
Now we are not even common
Maybe just the skin tone
But our architectures changed
like spades and jacks
No turning back?

I'd still give it another go
In fact, all the go's in the world
Wherever you are, feel longed for
Sincerely, the boy with the eyes four

SO I'M HERE

I look up I look down
Faces staring, it's like I should drown
I turn left and turn right
Happy faces, and there's me in fright

So I'm here

A 20 Hour drive ends here
To A destination frosted in fear
Hopes shattered, reality builds
Sought confidence, self slavery yielded

A place in dreams so envisioned
Sadly, to the dungeon I was commissioned
Pain, pain, pain
Let it rain rain rain

So I'm here

Is this what it's become
I thought the journey to life began
Time stopped a while ago

Infinitely stuck in a smoked Canva
Was it life? No. I see myself a cadaver

The Boy Who Almost Gave Up

There was a boy who used to laugh with his whole chest.
He believed in God. He believed in family.
He believed he was made for something more.

But life hit him.

First, it showed up in his skin, a rash, small and annoying.
Then it came in disappointment, results that didn't match his
prayers.

Then silence, people stopped checking in.
Then doubt, "Am I really who I thought I was?"

And slowly, piece by piece, he started disappearing inside.
He was still smiling. Still showing up. Still quoting verses.
But in private?
He felt weak. Forgotten. Unseen.

He didn't hate God
but he wondered if God had stepped back.
He felt like the golden child who lost his shine.
Even his own reflection started to feel like a stranger.

And no one saw.

Not his friends who told him to man up.
Not his parents who didn't know how much he was hurting.
Not even the church that once clapped for his potential.

But God saw.

One night, in the middle of one of those God, I'm tired moments
He whispered something to himself
I don't even know who I am anymore

And for the first time in a long time, he didn't feel alone.
No lightning. No angels singing.
Just stillness, peace and a deep voice in his spirit:

You are not your skin.
You are not your results.
You are not the shame you carry.
You are my son.
And I have not changed my mind about you

He broke. He cried
not because he was weak
but because he was still alive.
And somehow, that was proof that God hadn't left.

He didn't bounce back overnight.
But he got up the next morning and he started again.
He wrote down goals.
He deleted things that were stealing his peace.
He stopped shrinking himself to fit in.
He let go of some people.

He kept praying even when it felt dry.
He found God in the silence, not just the fire.

He wasn't hiding anymore.
Not from God.
Not from life.
Not from himself.

Now, he's becoming a man with vision.
He protects his mind.
He watches what he posts.
He treats his life like a brand, valuable, strategic, intentional.
He doesn't chase swag.
He builds legacy.

He prays before he plans.
He worships even when he's confused.
He asks God for wisdom like it's oxygen.
He builds his life on spirit, not on flesh.

He still battles urges.
He still gets tempted to give up.
But now he knows, God isn't after perfection
He's after progress.
And progress means showing up, even with shaky hands.

He used to think pain disqualified him
But now he knows, pain made him
ready He thought he was lost.
But he was only buried.
And now he's growing.

THREADS OF BECOMING

So if you ever see him smiling, worshiping, or dreaming again
just know, this is the boy who almost gave up
but didn't.

And now, he is becoming the man God always knew he'd be.
Living life not out of decree
Embracing the beauty of living, wild and free

Alas, alas
He is heading there
With shoes on or feet rooted bare
Young and strong or grayed hair
Freedom is the goal still

II

LIGHT THROUGH THE STORM

Even in shadowed corners, light finds a way to seep through. In moments that feel small, fragile, or fleeting, hope always whispers. These poems trace the gentle glimmers of resilience, the sparks that remind us: we can breathe again, even after the storm.

MY TIME WAS COMING

For the stars to appear it has to be dark
I cry each time I look back
I recall the times I used to wear a sack
For all the necessities I used to lack
That's a time of unspoken bad luck
So sad in that state for long i was stuck
Even my only relative turned his back
My thumbs so dirty I could not even suck

Little did I know
My time was coming

Though at that time I lacked smiles
I tried my best to walk uncountable miles
In that journey of life for a long while
For the road was not as smooth as a tile
But rather rough as a file
Indeed I had to fight

My time was coming

My betterment was what I fought for

I had to use my long horn
Many Surprised today I've won
Free as an electron
For sure
my time was coming

Now look at what my labour has brought
It has indeed brought a lot
A future worth calling a fruit
True it wasn't an easy route
The seeds took way long to sprout
But the harvests were worth it

I just had to believe
My time was coming

THE LIGHT IN THE DARK

Through the stormy nights you were his shelter,
A beacon of hope when his foundation was weak
Your words gave him courage when he felt like giving up,
He found strength to rise up and his spirit perked up

You lifted his head when he was bowed down in despair
Your light shone bright, And gave him hope to repair,
You noticed him when all he felt was disregarded,
Your compassion was medicine, for his emotional infection,
And when the emotions became chaotic
your support was catalytic through your reckless love

His heart was heavy, his spirit broken
But you were there to raise him up
He felt casted aside and you saw his value

Wonderful merciful saviour, that is you

FRACTURED LIGHT

The fear of letdown gives us no reason to try again
The people we trust are the ones who make it rain
The level of constant disappointments burdens us
Leaving us fed up, exhausted, and deeply burnt

The last resort becomes a loner's trend
From the dark trenches of the deep seas
To the silent sheds of the Amazon trees
A life spent on scavenging peace
And never does the urge to, ever seize

Solitude seems to guarantee
It gives us freedom, like genie to Aladdin
We think we've found it, and it was meant to be
But for how long does it last?
A present life burdened by the past
Memories inprinted like childhood scars
Satisfaction only enjoyed from the stars

It's a painful truth that no matter the comfort We enjoy in our
loner's zone
One day or another, we will feel alone

That is why we need people, real people
It's not bad luck that we encounter bad companions
It's just a reminder that not every shoulder, Is a leaning beacon

Be patient with your life, and keep your eyes open
If you're keen enough, you'll see one
Pure hearted, loving, supportive, shiny, and golden

It's that single encounter that changes the story
A new chapter, new pages, new setting and new characters
All in the same book, by the same narrator, YOU

The only limitation is that the past story
Can never resurface
But the new one has a milestone of pages to cover
Anything can happen, it's just up to the author

No man is an island
Keep your heart open
Don't be afraid

No matter the countless loops
A rollercoaster makes,
it'll still end up where it started then, the ground

You were born happy
You'll end up happy

THERE'S OKAY IN BARELY OKAY

I still remember it vividly

It was a bright Sunday afternoon
The Sky was sunny, clearer and blue
Boredom struck me to the core
I was so lonely and craved for more
So I decided to visit an old friend of mine
Since contact had been a really long time
The longing for connection I couldn't overlook
There was no stopping me, that taxi I had to book

When I arrived the rain was dropping

A stern face with her eye brows dropping
I asked her what's wrong and she said she was in heart
break Her boyfriend had dumped her and her life was a
train wreck I sat quiet and didn't know what to say
I understood her pain but it wasn't worth the tear stray
Momentary scars that could heal in a day
I told her to kneel and together we should pray

Before I departed I had to ask

"This is the last time that I'm gonna ask"
"How are you" she said barely okay

Then I said,

At least there's an okay in barely okay

I missed him, sad we had to meet in that way

My uncle, that had long been gone for years

Always dreamt he'd come and buy me a new bike

Before he bought it, his life was on spikes

The car he boarded to work overturned

Soon as I heard the news my heart burned

I wished I could help him, my hand I could lend

But he had Many bone fractures the doctors had to mend

Time flew fast and his recovery was quick

The moment he woke up he said he felt weak

to his surprise he couldn't feel his leg

A shouting stutter "where's my leg gone i beg"

He sobbed and sobbed and sat on the corner

If only he knew the length of his coma

I felt his loss, but gratitude was solace

At least on his own, foodstuffs he could forage

I asked him how are you he said barely okay

Then I said you know what,

In that theatre, someone is not even barely okay

A frustrated face behind the stage on that Christmas night

A few minutes before he performed that pluck

The strings of the guitar got tangled and stuck

He feared for his reputation

For an awful performance was what he never
had

It was the First day I saw the tears of a guitarist
From heartwarming melodies to the face of wist

But I comforted him, my hand on his wrist
A disheartened man behind a melody starving mist
There was no other way
He needed to save it for another day
Broken I knew otherwise he couldn't play

I asked him man how are you he said barely okay

I said you know what?
At least there's an okay in barely okay

So my friends, please take heart
Limitless are the desires of the heart
I understand we intermittently grieve our loss
But isn't happiness what matters the most?

A bird in hand is worth two in the bush
Why do you weep about an unsung flute
Ones life out there has just been put on mute

Let's learn to find joy in the simplest of things
True, human beings are complex beings
But Never let that ever make you feel weak

There's an okay in barely okay

III

INFINITE THOUGHTS

There are thoughts that stretch beyond the boundaries of language... drifting like stars across the mind's horizon, whispering of love, loss, and the quiet wars within. This section is a constellation of such fragments, where infinity is not measured in numbers, but in the weight of questions that never end. These poems are the echoes of the universe when it dares to speak through a human heart.

INFINIVERSE

In the infiniverse, where stars are born
And galaxies stretch beyond what's sworn
I find myself, a soul adrift
Yearning for the infinite, my heart's rift
Continuous echoes tuned by the joyful vocals
Pitched from the stretching of my Adam's apple
The light I see, not stained by a single bit of shade

In this resonance, I find my way
Through the infiniverse, night and
day A path unwinding, like a river's
flow Leading me to secrets, yet
unknown
Feeling contented with peace, I proudly show
From my head to the tip of my toe
No defined pattern, both columns and rows
The scent of freedom, the fragrance of rose

In this state of bliss, I find my voice
A melody that echoes, a heartfelt choice
To dance with the universe, wild and free
Embracing the beauty, that's meant to be

No death, just immortal beings
Blood nor pain, everyone sees
Clear vision, all keenest of sight
Free of sin, but moral delight

In this realm of wonder, we roam and play
Where love and wisdom guide us, every step of the way
With hearts full of kindness, and minds full of light
We dance through eternity, in pure delight

In wisdom and faith, we surely strive
Accumulators of spiritual will, our souls they drive
Bubbles of weakness and desperation
We remove the recess with amalgamation
Prayers solid and virtual, no apparition
All is real, see the mirror of redemption

WHAT IF

Ever wondered?

If birth had anesthesia

Would it have a meaning?

If labour bore no pain

Would it be fulfilling?

No

Some say pain marks the convenience of the being to come

The essence and soulful nature of that specific period of time

Word taking time right?

Negligible stings during birth

How would we even describe it

The divine creator had a reason

Metaphors in his words on this they reason

But what if birth had anesthesia

Would the value of a child even be appreciated

Would the existence alone be anything precious

We strive for eternal freedom

But would it be worth it
A word with no pain nor suffering
Salvation and liberty forever shimmering

Imagine how pain shapes a person
The determination and perseverance it instills
The purposeful life it creates
The goals and system It helps one set and build

Isn't it worth it
Wouldn't we miss that

A world without pain implies a world without boundaries
Where all life lies on the same meniscus
No high nor lower class
No worker no employee

ever wondered?

IF BIRTH HAD ANESTHESIA

Ever wondered?

If birth had anesthesia

Would it have a meaning?

If labour bore no pain

Would it be fulfilling? No

Some say pain marks the convenience of the being to come

The essence and soulful nature of that specific period of time

Word taking time right?

Negligible stings during birth

How would we even describe it

The divine creator had a reason

Metaphors in his words on this they reason

But what if birth had anesthesia

Would the value of a child even be appreciated

Would the existence alone be anything precious

We strive for eternal freedom

But would it be worth it

A word with no pain nor suffering

Salvation and liberty forever shimmering

Imagine how pain shapes a person

The determination and perseverance it instills

The purposeful life it creates

The goals and system It helps one set and build

Isn't it worth it

Wouldn't we miss that

A world without pain implies a world without boundaries

Where all life lies on the same meniscus

No high nor lower class

No worker no employee

ever wondered?

IV

SOCIETY AND REALITY CHECK

*This section stares at the world we live in... its masks,
its wounds, its strange traditions. The poems here
question what we've accepted as normal, and expose
the silent truths society often hides.*

WE'RE ALL CIRCUMCISED

We're all circumcised

In the midst of these jovial faces broken hearts lie
Among these agile hands and feet rests unbearable bitter pie
Tell me how are we not circumcised?
The pain and disappointments on our heads
The freedom we yearn for, worth priceless beads

We're all circumcised

Tell me who doesn't bare the weight of the evil doings of these
greedy politicians
Unfulfilled promises piercing through our skins
In their eyes were just little weaklings
Puppets to be used for deeds of their liking
How are we not circumcised
The sensation we endure like surgery without
anesthesia So sad such moments always linger

We're all circumcised

We spend over half our lives grappling knowledge in school
All to secure high paying jobs and look cool
But belated success never loosens from our skin
Like juicy sutures and gauze clinging together

Hurt feeling and thoughts seem forever

We're all circumcised

One sources capital to start a business
Humble beginnings his hands can witness
but then taxes seem to be the weakness
Setbacks sharp as the theatre scapels
Between profits and taxes we he has to tackle
Hell Caesar

We're all circumcised

An innocent young lady can't access a job without offering
her body as sacrifice

She's nothing else than mere merchandise
You hear the boss say there's a price to pay
To get the spot on her he must lay
How are we not circumcised

They tell an intern to have 10 years experience so he can sit
on the chair

How can a person's heart be polluted as air
Swollen eyes like day two of circumcision
The torture overflows with no restrictions

We're all circumcised

Tell me why do decisions made by the leaders only impact
the poor citizens

You decline peaceful agreements In the comfort of your
offices

Yet the effects of the atomic bombs and missiles are felt by
the innocents

How are we not circumcised

Lost hope aching and burning in our hearts like iodine
Resentment we can't digest like ptyalin
Grinding hard for the final aesthetic prospective
Or so we think

We're all circumcised

What crime do people born with the defective melanin gene
commit

They can't even go jog to stay fit
Fearing the hungry predators of their own species
Confined like astronauts in space suits
Caught up in circles of freedom pursuit
The able enter DAPP stores to sweep of the remaining cheap
clothes

Leaving the high priced ones for the poor
Tears from our eyes never seize to pour

We're all circumcised

Who hasn't felt the excruciating pain of this world
We can't even pronounce the word
That describes what we're going through
Or whatever we're about to
It's clear we might need another set of eyes
These two are burdened by a stream of tears they failed to
handle

The peace we once enjoyed now we just mumble
Upon paradisaical life we stumble

By now everyone has realised

Truly, we're all circumcised

Closing Thoughts

To those who shaped my journey — my friends, family, mentors, and God — this collection is a tribute to your support and presence.

Jeremiah 29:11 – “For I know the plans I have for you, declares the Lord, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.”